

NEVA NETWORK · DESIGN SPEC

Six-Month Grid

An EVE-inspired data-grid sandbox built on the existing M00–M20 base.

Date 2026-05-28

Authors Max + Claude (Opus 4.7)

Base repo /Users/max/nevanetwork

Status Approved direction · implementation plan pending

Companion docs/superpowers/specs/2026-05-28-data-grid-game-design.md

NEVA NETWORK — "Six-Month Grid" Design Spec

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Scope: Turn the existing Mission 00–20 base into a 6+ month, event-driven, EVE-inspired single-player experience with four asymmetric class loops.

0. Executive Summary (one-page TL;DR)

NEVA Network already ships as a 20-mission narrative puzzle game about decoding a corrupted data grid. **This spec extends it into a long-lived experience** structured around

8-week Seasons (Path of Exile league cadence) where players choose one of **four** asymmetric classes to act in a shared world of nodes, data, and factions.

- **Months 0–3 (Season 0 — "First Cipher"):** Existing M00–M20 wraps as the **prologue**; daily/weekly event layer launches in Sector A02 for the **Operator** class only.
- **Months 3–5 (Season 1): Corsair** class ships (breach-and-run).
- **Months 5–7 (Season 2): Ghost** class ships (possession / spread).
- **Months 7–10 (Season 3): Architect** class ships (build-and-defend, async).
- **Months 10+:** Sandbox-AI faction layer; UGC; eventual token economy (Sharia/legal gated).

Players will be retained by three nested loops:

1. **Daily Contract (≤ 15 min)** — quick, procedural, faction-flavored.
2. **Weekly Anomaly (1–2 h)** — multi-stage, leaderboard, story-bearing.
3. **Seasonal Tentpole (8 weeks)** — narrative arc with permanent reward at finale.

Content is sustained via **hybrid event sourcing**: NEVA Core LLM drafts events from a template library, you (Max) approve/edit in an admin panel, scheduler pushes to live players. ~20 minutes per event vs. 2–3 hours hand-authored.

No token in this spec, but the economy is architected as a **token-ready abstraction**

so a future Sharia-and-legal-cleared utility + earn + governance token can plug in.

1. Vision & Three Pillars

Vision statement

*NEVA Network is a long-lived single-player "data grid" sandbox. You are an **Operator** (or Corsair, Ghost, Architect) acting on a 3D holographic network that changes every week. The grid has weather. The factions have agendas. The finale is never the same season twice.*

Three Pillars (borrowed from EVE Online, adapted)

#	Pillar	What it means here
1	Systemic, not scripted	Build mechanisms that interact. Avoid hand-authored content treadmills.
2	Class-asymmetric, world-shared	Four classes see/do <i>different things</i> in the <i>same grid</i> . They are complementary, not parallel.
3	Seasons over patches	The 8-week season is the rhythm. Theme, hook, climax, reset. The drumbeat is the product.

What we explicitly REJECT

- ❌ "Patch every two weeks" treadmills (Destiny 2 is abandoning this in 2026 — content burnout).
 - ❌ Hand-authoring every event (unsustainable for a solo dev).
 - ❌ Hard economy resets that wipe player progress (the *base* persists; sector + season buffs reset).
 - ❌ Real-money pay-to-win or pay-to-progress mechanics.
 - ❌ Premature MMO scope (single-player + async social only, until proven).
-

2. Nested Core Loop

NEVA Network is structured as **three loops, nested by time-scale**.



Daily loop (≤ 15 min)

1. Login → see **Daily Contract** card on HUD (faction-flavored, class-relevant).
2. Travel to target node → execute class-signature action (Decode / Breach / Possess / Defend).
3. Claim reward (Lore Shards, Black Credits, Coherence, or Grid Power).
4. Streak counter increments (5-, 10-, 20-day streak unlocks).

Weekly loop (1–2 h)

1. **Anomaly** unlocks each Monday at 00:00 UTC — appears as a glowing event-node on the grid.
2. Multi-stage event (typically 4–7 stages, branching).
3. Earns higher-tier currency + cosmetic + faction reputation + lore page.
4. Asynchronous leaderboard (no real-time PvP — submission-based).

Seasonal loop (8 weeks)

1. Week 1: **Reveal** — landing page + in-game broadcast + opening cinematic.
2. Weeks 2–4: **Spread** — anomalies escalate in difficulty; faction reputation matters.
3. Week 4: **Twist** — story turns; new mechanic unlocks.
4. Weeks 5–7: **Build** to climax.
5. Week 7: **Finale Tentpole** — limited-time multi-hour mission; permanent unlock granted.
6. Week 8: **Cooldown** — Nightwave-style interim. All rerunnable. No FOMO.

Soft Reset (between seasons)

What persists vs. what resets:

Persists (account-wide)	Resets each season
Player profile (callsign, level, history)	Sector A02 seed (regenerates)
Class XP and unlocked skills	Season-only buffs and modifiers
Architect's base / private grid	Season leaderboard
Lore unlocks & achievements	Faction reputation (carries 20%)
Cosmetics & cipher tools	Daily / Weekly progress

This is the PoE soft-reset model. Returning players come back to *new* without losing identity.

3. The Four Classes

Class summary table

Class	Signature mechanic	Core tools	Currency	Fantasy	Ship phase
Operator	DECODE — cipher puzzles on nodes (Caesar → frequency → pattern → symbolic)	Cipher Tablet, Pattern Lens	Lore Shards	Detective / archaeologist / philosopher	Season 0 (existing M00–M20 mechanics reused)
Corsair	BREACH-AND-RUN — timed intrusion; ICE reacts; trace path, dodge alarms, exfil before lockdown	Spoofers, Ghost-tail, Snip	Black Credits	Cyberpunk runner — high-tension	Season 1
Ghost	POSSESSION — become nodes; spread "presence"; each node grants a power; manage Coherence budget	Tendrils, Echo, Resonate	Coherence	SOMA / Soul Hackers — philosophical	Season 2
Architect	BUILD-AND-DEFEND — construct private grid; cipher walls, ICE traps; async raids while away	Wall, Trap, Tap (yield node)	Grid Power	Factorio + tower defense + Stardew	Season 3

Per-class detail

3.1 Operator (Season 0)

- **Loop:** Locate node → analyze signature → identify cipher type → solve → extract DATA.
- **Skill tree (20 skills):** Cipher-type unlocks (Caesar, Vigenère, frequency, symbol-substitution,

graph-walk, light-physics, NEVA-whisper interpretation, etc.).

- **Signature ability (Mastery 4):** "Echo Read" — view another operator's solved-path on a node.
- **Reuses:** ~80% of M00–M20 systems. **Lowest engineering risk.**

3.2 Corsair (Season 1)

- **Loop:** Survey target sector → pick entry vector → execute timed breach → exfil → fence data on a black market (NPC).
- **Skill tree:** Stealth, route obfuscation, ICE-knowledge, multi-node chaining.
- **Signature ability:** "Cold Trail" — leave a fake path that ICE follows for N seconds.
- **New systems needed:** ICE/timer subsystem, black-market vendor, breach-timer HUD.

3.3 Ghost (Season 2)

- **Loop:** Find resonant nodes → infest (Tendrill) → grow Coherence → unlock memory fragments → confront SELF (a hallucinated rival operator).
- **Skill tree:** Possession depth, coherence economy, mass-resonance, echo recall.
- **Signature ability:** "Singularity" — collapse a node-cluster into a permanent personal anchor.
- **New systems needed:** Coherence resource, possession graph overlay, lore-fragment system.

3.4 Architect (Season 3)

- **Loop:** Survey personal sector → build (walls, ICE, taps) → defend (async raids) → harvest yield → upgrade.
- **Skill tree:** Build economy, ICE design, encryption tiers, raid-defense replays.
- **Signature ability:** "Bastion Mode" — your base broadcasts on the public grid as a notable landmark; visiting it grants other players a small reward.
- **New systems needed:** Base persistence, async raid replay system (Clash-of-Clans-style), offline yield calculator, leaderboards for "most-attacked / best-defended."

Cross-class interactions (the "EVE feel")

- **Corsair** steals encrypted data → **Operator** decrypts faster → split rewards.
- **Ghost** can infest an **Architect**'s base → Architect defends (asynchronously).
- **Operator** can read **Ghost**'s past Echo paths.
- Multi-classing is allowed; pick a primary, dabble. There is no exclusivity gate.

Shared progression layer

- **Operator Profile** (already exists, from the original nevanetwork "Player Profile / Phase 7" work — not to be confused with this spec's roadmap phases) is the account-wide spine. Persists everything.

- **Class Mastery:** 4 tiers per class. Granted by completing a season in that role.
- **Account-wide unlocks:** Cosmetics, lore pages, achievements, NEVA Core ranks.

4. Season Structure & Event System

Season anatomy (8-week pacing)

Week: 12345678

| Reveal | Spread | Pressure | Twist | Build | Climax | Finale | Cooldown

| | | | | | | |

Story: Tentpole introMid-arc revealTentpole finaleLore epilogue

Daily: Easy contractsMediumHardBrutalMixed

Weekly Anomaly: A1A2A3A4A5A6A7 (rerun)

Modifier: Season Mechanic active throughout (e.g. "Corruption Tide")

The Four Event Archetypes (the AI generation library)

Every event is one of these. Templates with slots. This is why AI can author them sustainably.

Archetype	What it is	Daily form (15 min)	Weekly form (1–2 h)
Breach	Get IN, get data, get OUT. Combat-of-puzzles.	1 node, 1 cipher, time limit	Multi-node chain, ICE escalation
Anomaly	Something weird in the grid — investigate, document.	Single weird node, 1 question	5-node mystery, branching lore
Faction Op	One of 4 in-world factions wants something. Reputation outcomes.	"Deliver X data to Faction Y"	Full mission with twist + betrayal option
Tide	World-wide modifier event. Affects everyone for N days.	N/A	"Corruption Tide for 48h: nodes pulse, decryption costs 2x but loot doubled"

Event generation pipeline

Archetype template + Season theme + Seed

↓

NEVA Core LLM drafts: nodes, cipher type, narration, rewards

↓

Admin Event Editor (Max reviews/edits – ~20 min per event)

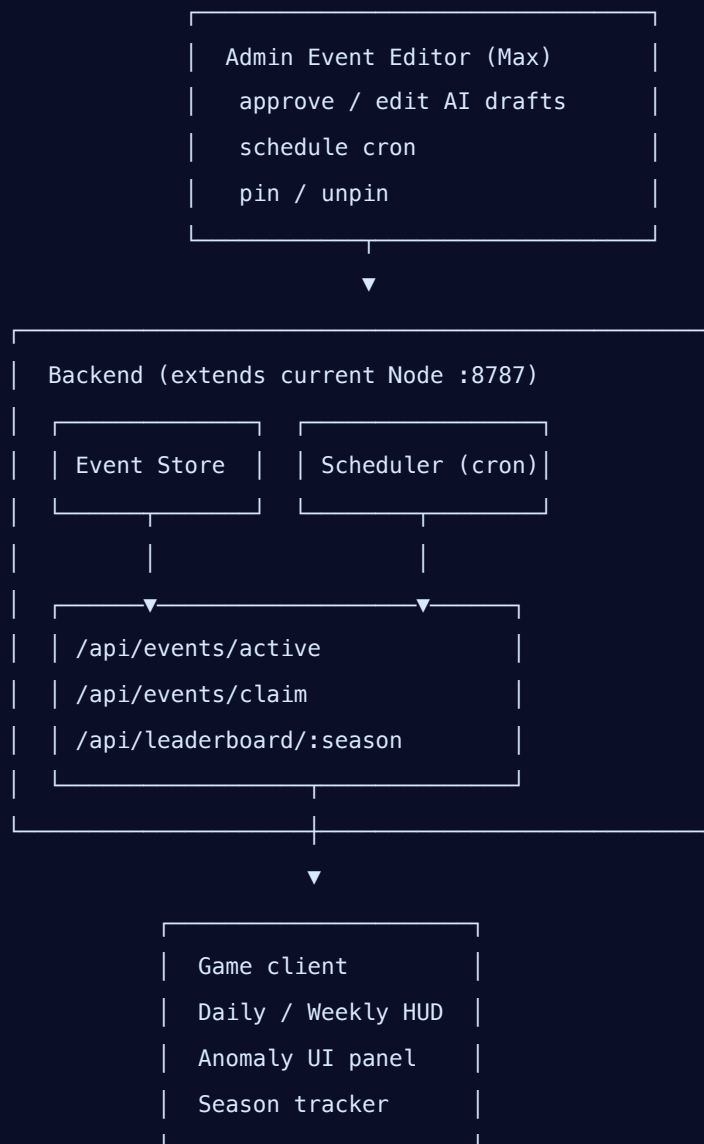
↓

Event Scheduler (cron)

↓

/api/events/active served to game client

Event System Architecture



Implementation notes:

- All event content lives **server-side**, fetched on login.

- Save remains local (`save.ts`); **rewards/claims** ping the server (idempotent).
- Offline players catch up next login — no FOMO. Missed weekly Anomalies always rerun in Cooldown week.
- Backend extends the existing Phase 8 zero-dep server (no DB, JSON stores) for Season 0;

introduce SQLite at Season 1 when event volume justifies it.

Sample Season 0 — "First Cipher" (the alpha)

- **Theme:** The grid is waking up. Strange pulses in the deep network.
- **Mechanic:** First exposure to NEVA Core *unreliable* whispers — hints sometimes lie.
- **Tentpole story:** Track the pulse source → discover it is an *older operator's echo* → confront and absorb their cipher techniques.
- **Reward at finale:** Permanent "**Pattern Lens**" unlock (visual filter on all future nodes).
- **Reused content:** Existing Missions 00–20 become **Season 0 Prologue** — finishing M20

unlocks the seasonal layer. Players who already finished M20 skip the prologue.

5. Economy, Progression, and Token-Ready Architecture

Currencies (all in-game, no blockchain in this spec)

Currency	Earned by	Spent on	Persistence
DATA (existing)	Decoding nodes	Tool upgrades, base modules	Per season
Memory Shards (existing)	Mission completion	Cipher analysis, identity	Account-wide
Access Keys (existing)	Faction Ops	Unlocking firewalls	Per season
Signal Energy (existing)	Cooldown weeks, streaks	Boosting actions	Per season
Core Fragments (existing)	Tentpole finales	Permanent class unlocks	Account-wide
Lore Shards (<i>new — Operator</i>)	Daily Contracts	Lore archive	Account-wide
Black Credits (<i>new — Corsair</i>)	Breach exfiles, fencing	Tools, contracts	Per season
Coherence (<i>new — Ghost</i>)	Possession	Permanent grid bonds	Account-wide
Grid Power (<i>new — Architect</i>)	Yield taps	Base expansion	Account-wide

Progression structure



Token-Ready Abstraction

Per the user's long-term intent, the economy is architected so a token can plug in

after Sharia + legal review clears.

```

In-game Currency Wallet (Phase 0)
  |  abstract interface
  ▼
class WalletProvider {
  balance(currency)
  spend(currency, amount, reason)
  earn(currency, amount, source)
  transferable: bool ← always false today
}
  |
  |  later swap-in:
  ▼
On-Chain Wallet Provider (Phase 7+, after legal)
– Same interface, real on-chain transfer
– Token contract address per currency

```

Architectural rules (enforced from Day 1):

- All currency mutations go through `WalletProvider` — no direct `state.data += 10`.
- Every `spend` / `earn` carries a **reason code** (audit trail for future on-chain proofs).
- "Transferability" is a per-currency flag, **always false in this spec**.
- No currency-balance UI labels mention "tokens," "coins," "crypto," or wallet addresses.

When the token decision is made (Phase 7+), only the `WalletProvider` implementation changes.

No gameplay code needs rewriting. **No Web3 dependencies added before that decision.**

Sharia/Legal Pre-Conditions (for future token activation)

Token integration is BLOCKED until ALL of:

- Independent Sharia review (gharar / maisir / qimar analysis).
- Independent legal review (US + EU + KSA + UAE securities law).
- Whitepaper draft + audit-firm pre-screen.
- Clear utility-vs-security classification.

Until then, the abstraction is just clean code hygiene.

6. Integration with the Existing NEVA Network Base

What we keep AS-IS

- **Missions 00–20** remain canonical (CLAUDE.md guardrail). They become **Season 0 Prologue**.

- **Sector A01** stays the tutorial / story zone.
- **Sector A02** procedural grid (`sectorGen.ts`) becomes the **Seasonal World** — regenerates each season with new seed.

- **NEVA Core AI** (backend OpenAI) gains a second responsibility: drafting event content.
- **Player Profile** (Phase 7, local-only) gains class progression fields.
- **Backend** (`server/` , Phase 8 zero-dep) extends with Event Store + Scheduler.
- **Landing page** gains a "Current Season" tile.

What we EXTEND

- **Save** (`save.ts`) — additive migration v2: add `classProgression` , `seasonState` , `wallet` .

Old saves load fine; new fields default-initialized.

- **HUD** — add Daily Contract slot (top-right), Season tracker (top-left), Anomaly indicator (grid).
- **NEVA Terminal** (Space) — new commands: `season status` , `season claim` , `class switch` .
- **Inspection Panel** — gain class-specific action buttons (Decode / Breach / Possess / Defend).

What we ADD (new modules — see Roadmap §7)

- `seasons.ts` — Season state, soft-reset logic.
- `classes/operator.ts` , `classes/corsair.ts` , `classes/ghost.ts` , `classes/architect.ts` .
- `events/archetype-{breach,anomaly,faction,tide}.ts` .
- `wallet.ts` — currency abstraction.
- `server/events/` — Event Store, Scheduler, Admin Editor backend.
- `server/admin-event-editor/` — minimal admin UI (auth-gated by existing `NEVA_ADMIN_SECRET`).
- `server/ai-event-drafter.ts` — NEVA Core LLM event-template filler.

Guardrails respected from existing CLAUDE.md

- ☒ Missions 00–20 NOT renumbered or rewritten.
- ☒ HUD QUICK CONTROLS / TARGET NODE NOT reintroduced.
- ☒ No token / Web3 / payments in this spec (abstraction only).
- ☒ NEVA Core stays advisory; never mutates save/missions/rewards.
- ☒ Player Profile remains local-only and identity-only in this spec.
- ☒ Phase 8 backend remains zero-dep until Season 1 (then SQLite).
- ☒ Admin endpoints stay gated by `NEVA_ADMIN_SECRET` .

7. Roadmap

Phases (each ~2 months unless noted)

Phase	Name	Duration	Headline Deliverable	Class added
0	Foundation	4 weeks	Wallet abstraction, Season state, Daily Contract scaffolding	(Operator only — existing)
1	Season 0 — "First Cipher"	8 weeks	First playable seasonal alpha; Operator class polished	—
2	Season 1 — "Black Routes"	8 weeks	Corsair class shipped; ICE + breach-timer	Corsair
3	Season 2 — "The Echo Below"	8 weeks	Ghost class shipped; Possession graph	Ghost
4	Season 3 — "Bastion"	12 weeks	Architect class shipped; async base raids	Architect
5	Stretch — Sandbox AI Layer	12+ weeks	Faction AI (toward Approach A); UGC tools	—
6	Stretch — Token Activation	Gated	After Sharia + legal clear; WalletProvider swap	—

Phase 0 milestone gates (the "ship Season 0" checklist)

1. `wallet.ts` exists; all currency mutations route through it. Audit grep passes.
2. `seasons.ts` exists; save migration v2 in place; old saves load green.
3. `/api/events/active` returns at least one daily + one weekly event.
4. Admin Event Editor at `/admin/events` (NEVA_ADMIN_SECRET-gated).
5. Daily Contract HUD card renders + completes + claims reward.
6. Weekly Anomaly opens in Sector A02 + completes + claims reward.
7. Season tracker UI shows weeks 1–8 with current week highlighted.
8. `pnpm build` is green (real typecheck gate).
9. Full M00–M20 still plays (no regression).

Phase 1 milestone gates (the "Season 0 launch" checklist)

1. Season 0 tentpole arc playable end-to-end.
2. NEVA Core unreliable-whisper system shipped.
3. 7 weekly Anomalies authored (or AI-drafted) and scheduled.
4. ~30 daily Contracts in the rotation pool.
5. Leaderboard for Season 0 weekly Anomalies online.
6. Pattern Lens permanent unlock awarded on finale.
7. Soft-reset transition to Season 1 prep tested in staging.

8. No regressions on M00–M20.

8. Risks & Mitigations

#	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
1	Content burnout (solo dev can't sustain)	High	Critical	AI-first event drafting; templates; ~20 min/event budget
2	Soft-reset annoys hoarders	Medium	Medium	Clear messaging; architect base persists; cosmetics persist
3	Class balancing	Medium	Medium	Ship one class at a time; tune live; no PvP, so imbalance is tolerable
4	Scope creep into MMO	High	Critical	This spec explicitly forbids it; revisit only after Phase 4
5	LLM event drafts low quality	Medium	High	Max approval gate before publish; template constraints
6	Token decision lock-in too early	Low	High	WalletProvider abstraction; no Web3 deps until Phase 6
7	Player session drift (everyone plays once per month)	Medium	Medium	Daily streak rewards; weekly anomaly FOMO-buffer (rerun week 8)
8	Multi-class confusion	Medium	Low	UI defaults to primary class; switching is explicit in NEVA Terminal
9	Save migration breaks	Low	Critical	Additive migration only; comprehensive regression test on M00–M20
10	NEVA Core OpenAI cost spike	Low	Medium	Server-side cap per day; fallback to template-only mode

9. Glossary

Term	Definition
Operator	The player. Existing nevanetwork archetype. Also the default class.
Sector A01	The first sector — Memory Grid. M00–M20 live here (Season 0 prologue).
Sector A02	The Seasonal World. Procedurally regenerates each season.
Daily Contract	15-min daily event. Procedurally generated.
Anomaly	1–2h weekly event. Hand-authored or AI-drafted.
Tentpole	The seasonal climactic story event. Limited-time.
Soft Reset	End-of-season event: sector regenerates, season buffs expire, account-wide gains persist.
Tide	World-wide modifier event affecting all players for N hours.
NEVA Core	The in-game AI assistant. Advisory. Now also drafts event content.
WalletProvider	Currency abstraction. Token-swap point.
Class Mastery	4-tier per-class progression earned by playing a season as that class.

10. Implementation Appendix (for /goal execution)

This appendix is structured so a Claude Code `/goal` session can iterate on it.

Phase 0 Goal candidate

/goal Implement Phase 0 foundation modules for the Six-Month Grid plan (wallet.ts, seasons.ts, save migration v2, /api/events/active, Daily Contract HUD card).

Done when:

- All Phase 0 milestone gates (§7) pass.
- `pnpm build` exits 0.
- `pnpm lint` exits 0.
- Manual smoke: M00-M20 still completes; Daily Contract appears + completes + claims.
- No new `any` or `@ts-ignore`.
- No Web3 dependencies added (audit `package.json`).

Constraints:

- Do not modify Missions 00-20 logic.
- Do not introduce a token, wallet-connect, or smart-contract module.
- All currency mutations must route through wallet.ts.
- Backend stays zero-dep until SQLite is justified.

Stop after 25 turns max.

Module map (Phase 0)


```

src/
  wallet.ts           ← currency abstraction (NEW)
  seasons.ts         ← season state (NEW)
  save.ts            ← migration v2 (EXTEND)
  events/
    archetype-breach.ts      (NEW)
    archetype-anomaly.ts     (NEW)
    archetype-faction.ts     (NEW)
    archetype-tide.ts        (NEW)
  classes/
    operator.ts             (NEW; existing logic moved here)
  components/
    DailyContractCard.tsx   (NEW)
    SeasonTracker.tsx       (NEW)
server/
  events/
    store.mjs               (NEW – JSON file-backed)
    scheduler.mjs           (NEW – cron-like)
    routes.mjs              (NEW – /api/events/*)
  ai-event-drafter.mjs      (NEW – NEVA Core event template fill)
  admin-event-editor.html    (NEW – minimal admin UI)

```

Subsequent phases will be specified in their own /goal directives once Phase 0 lands.

11. Open Questions (review before Phase 0 /goal)

1. **Faction names + lore** — 4 in-world factions are needed for Faction Op events. Suggested:

The Archive, Black Loop, Quiet Pattern, Severance. Confirm or rename in review.

1. **Daily reset time** — UTC midnight? Player local-tz? (Suggest UTC for simplicity.)

2. **Streak grace** — does a missed day break the streak immediately, or is there a 24h grace?

(Suggest 24h grace + 1 per week.)

1. **Anomaly leaderboard scope** — global, friends-only, or both? (Suggest global asynchronous.)

2. **Cosmetic system** — node-trail effects? Class skin tints? UI themes? (All three eventually.)

3. **Steam/itch release** — Phase 4 or Phase 5? (Phase 5 — after Architect ships.)

End of design spec. Implementation plan to follow via writing-plans skill.